

The latest release of Ubuntu will also be bundled with the December 2018 issue of *Open Source For You*.

"Ubuntu is now the world's reference platform for AI engineering and analytics," said Mark Shuttleworth, CEO of Canonical. "We accelerate developer productivity and help enterprises operate at speed and at scale, across multiple clouds and diverse edge appliances," he added.

The new Yaru theme, formerly Communitheme, gives Ubuntu a fresh look in the latest release. It also gives Ubuntu a new style, while improving usability with semantic colour usage and better integration with the GNOME desktop.

Ubuntu 18.10 is based on the Linux release series 4.18. It includes support for AMD Radeon RX Vega M graphics processor, for the Raspberry Pi 3B and the 3B+, Qualcomm Snapdragon 845, and features many USB 3.2 and Type-C improvements, Intel Cannonlake graphics and significant power savings improvements. Other features include P-State driver support for Skylake X servers, POWER memory protection keys support, KVM support for AMD Secure Encrypted Virtualization, enablement of Shared Memory Communications remote and direct (SMC-R/D), Open for Business (OFB), and zcrypt on IBM Z, among many other improvements since the v4.15 kernel shipped in 18.04 LTS.

"OpenSSL, the secure communication library that uses the TLS protocol, is upgraded to 1.1.1 long term support series. It supports the recently approved TLSv1.3 standard. Multiple client and server applications have been enabled to use TLSv1.3 by default in Ubuntu 18.10, with many more to come in the next release," said sources at Canonical.

The new release also comes with a modern toolbox consisting of GNU C library (Glibc) 2.28, GNU Compiler Collection (GCC) 8.2, OpenSSL 1.1.1, Python 3.6.7 (default) and 3.7.1, Boost 1.67, Ruby 2.5.1, Perl 5.26.2, PHP 7.2.10, Golang 1.10.4, Rust 1.28 and OpenJDK 11.

LTSI to support Linux 4.14 for the next two to three years

The Linux Foundation's LTSI (Long-Term Support Initiative) group has confirmed on Twitter that the next LTS Linux kernel version to be supported for the following two to three years will be Linux 4.14.

The LTSI is a collaborative project to create and maintain the kernel for the industry. It offers cutting-edge device support as well as security and bug-fix patches. The project aims to provide hardware vendors using the Linux kernel in their products with support for at least two to three years.

Farewell, application menus!

The application menu on the GNOME desktop environment is what you see and interact with via the top panel, with the name of the app on it. When clicking on that app menu, you're usually quitting the app or accessing its preferences.

"These menus have been with us since the beginning of the GNOME 3.0 series, but we're planning on retiring them for the next GNOME release (version 3.32)," said Allan Day, a core member of GNOME's design team in a blog post.

The developers also said that, "Unfortunately, we've seen app menus not performing well over the years, despite efforts to improve them. People don't always engage with them. Often, they haven't realised that the menus are interactive, or they haven't remembered that they're there."

As such, it looks like GNOME 3.30 is the last version of the Linux desktop environment to use these application menus.

IPFire on Amazon Cloud

IPFire maintainer Michael Tremer has announced the availability of a new version of the open source firewall distribution and intrusion detection and prevention system.

The new release, IPFire 2.21 – Core Update 124, comes with new features and immensely improves the security and performance of the whole system.

"IPFire is ideal to securely connect your infrastructure to the cloud by using IPsec VPNs and



provides throughput of multiple tens of gigabits per second," said Michael Tremer.

"But IPFire can also be used as a small instance that protects your Web, mail and other servers in the cloud with the IPFire intrusion detection and prevention system, load balance Web traffic and do many more things," he added.

He also mentioned that, "For those who have SSH access enabled, it will now require the latest ciphers and key exchange algorithms that make the key handshake and connection not only more secure, but also faster when transferring data. For those admins who use the console, the SSH client has also been enabled to show a graphic representation of the SSH key presented by the server so that comparing those is easier, and man-in-the-middle attacks can be spotted quickly and easily."

The new release is now available on AWS EC2. This is sponsored by Lightning Wire Labs and provides a virtual cloud appliance that is set up within minutes and provides the full set of features of IPFire.



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